Although all of us agreed the Soviets were cheating on the SALT limits, we knew it might be difficult to prove it before the court of world opinion because of ambiguities in the treaties.

For the moment, I decided on a policy of guarded and cautious restraint, as these entries of my diary during June 1985 indicate:

> *June 4*
>
> An N.S.C. meeting about what to do about the SALT II treaty provisions we and the Soviets are pledged to observe but on which they are cheating. Come Sept., under our agreement we'd have to dismantle a Poseidon missile submarine. I was again presented five options with no consensus on any of them. Our allies want us to continue observing SALT II. I must have an answer before Monday . . .

> *June 6*
>
> I made my decision on the SALT II matter. We will continue to practice restraint on the building of nuclear weapons. That restraint will keep us generally within the frame work of the SALT II but only commensurate with the Soviets' observance of the SALT II restraints and for only as long as the Soviets abide by SALT II restraints.

> *June 10*
>
> . . . today we told Congress and the world what we intended doing about SALT II. Apparently my decision was right—at least I'm being called a statesman by both the left and right.

A few days later, I got a tough letter from Gorbachev in which he attacked our deployment of the Pershing II and cruise missiles in Europe as well as the qualifications I'd